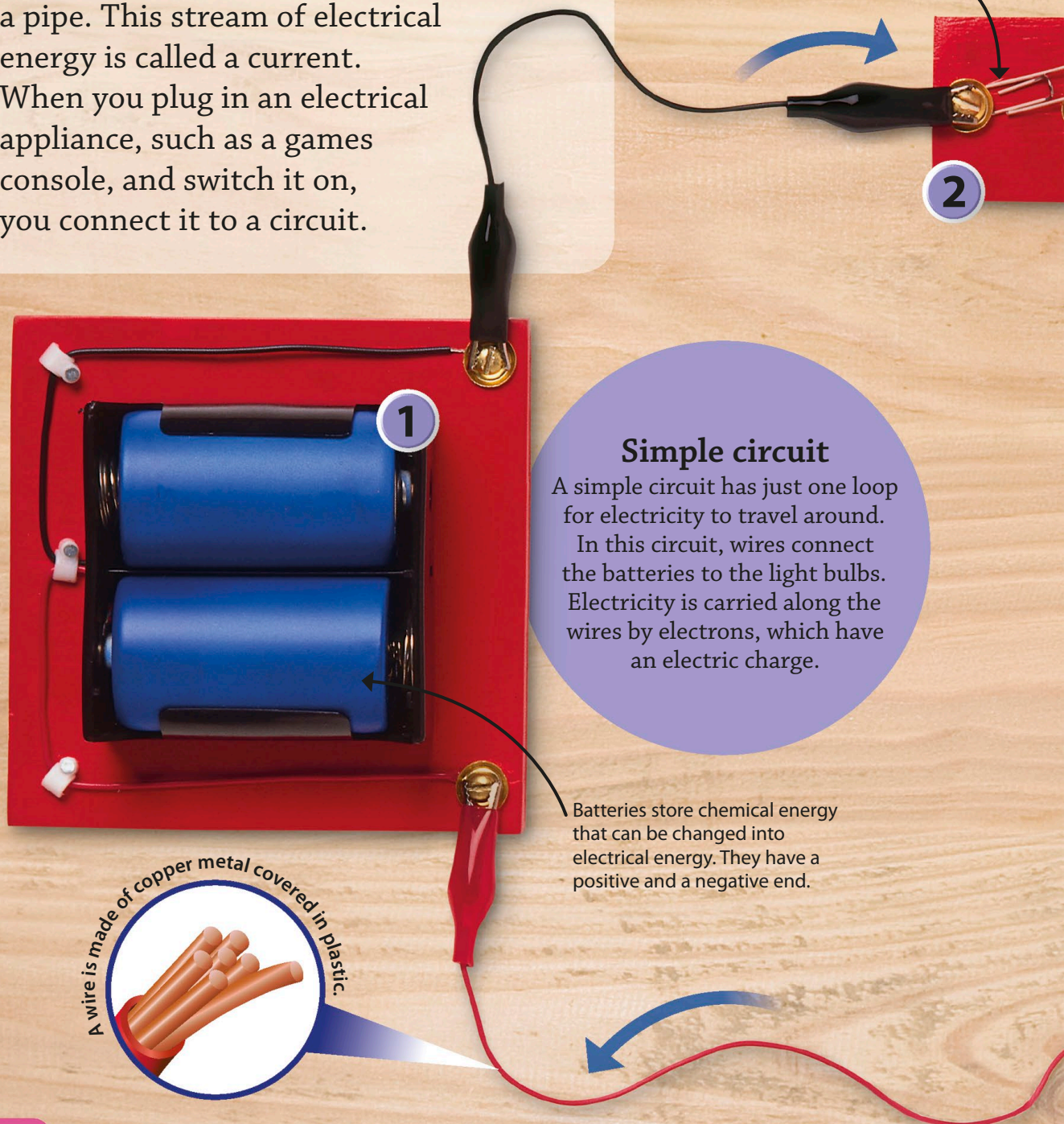


Circuits

A circuit is a loop that electricity flows through, like water flows through a pipe. This stream of electrical energy is called a current.

When you plug in an electrical appliance, such as a games console, and switch it on, you connect it to a circuit.

A switch allows a temporary gap to be made in a circuit so electricity can't flow around it.



2

Simple circuit

A simple circuit has just one loop for electricity to travel around.

In this circuit, wires connect the batteries to the light bulbs. Electricity is carried along the wires by electrons, which have an electric charge.

Batteries store chemical energy that can be changed into electrical energy. They have a positive and a negative end.

A wire is made of copper metal covered in plastic.